

**MI&CT eSERVICE NOTE
SN08112010a**

Class C information. Property of GE Healthcare

Date: 11/20/2008

Subject: VCT Site High Detector Module Failure Rates Qty > 4 modules /12 months

Effectivity: VCT 32/64 slice systems

Details:

Several VCT sites have experienced relatively high detector module failure rate, resulting in repeated customer downtime. Sites with high detector module failure rates (Greater than 4 modules over a 12 month period) may be the result of environmental drivers, some of which can lead to rapid system degradation.

There are two types of VCT Das/Detectors released, VDAS (Sherlock Detector) and HDAS (HALO Detector). Both of these VCT detectors have shown excellent detector module reliability. Most systems do not experience module failures annually. Systems that have been exposed to unfavorable shipping, storage and/or operating environments can experience higher failure rates. The root cause failure mode can be confirmed via analytical tests on autopsied field returns from sites.

Resolution:

Escalate via CSO process & author a field complaint for any site experiencing more than 4 module replacements in a 12-month period.

Assure all failed modules are returned via the normal consumable/returnable process. Autopsy confirmation of specific root cause will drive site-specific mitigation strategy.

All VCT detector modules are sent back to CT Detector Engineering through the consumable/returnable process and are autopsied to look for failure signatures and trends for continuous product improvement opportunities. A feedback form was introduced in Service Note SN06112814a and is included in every module FRU kit. The information sent back with the module is very helpful to the autopsy process. Please fill out this form with each module used for all details known about the failure mode experienced. As of today only a couple forms have been filled out and returned with the module since 2006.

Changes have been implemented in FRU's and new products to improve forward production from autopsy information.

Affected Service Publication:

NA

Tracking Number (Complaint # or SPR #):

iTrak# 13209584

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